

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Miss Sumayya Shaik

Address: 22 Effingham Close Sutton SM2 6AG

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to express my support for the planning application DM2025/01591.

I am a local resident and a current student, and I have lived in Sutton for the past ten years. Over this time, I have come to value the importance of having accessible community spaces that foster connection, belonging, and mutual support. The proposed development would provide a dedicated space where individuals with shared interests and beliefs can meet, build positive relationships, and strengthen community ties.

While I did not regularly attend BASMA events or prayers during my earlier years, I have since come to appreciate the importance of having a suitable and welcoming space for prayer and community engagement. In particular, as a student, I believe this new space would offer valuable opportunities to connect with others of a similar age, helping to build trusted relationships within the local Muslim community.

Additionally, the building is on a modest scale and will be a low-intensity use compared to other alternative developments. This place of worship and community hub will help develop the health and well-being programmes, as well as act as a community space.

I understand that some objections to the application relate to traffic, congestion, and health and safety concerns due to neighbouring schools. However, the proposal includes 12 on-site parking spaces, including two disabled bays, as well as cycle racks to encourage sustainable travel. Furthermore, Friday prayers are staggered to minimise overlap and reduce potential congestion during school pick-up times. Based on the proposed measures and the typically orderly transition

between prayer sessions, I do not believe the development would result in significant traffic disruption or noise issues.

Importantly, this place of worship and community hub will introduce more opportunities for women and children. A bigger space for women to pray and have activities will strengthen the sisters' community. It will also act as a space for educational programmes for younger children to help them grow up in a supportive and loving community.

I respectfully request that the Sutton Council approve this application.